Q. What was running through your head before the final against Michelle Li in Birmingham?
Even though I had beaten her at the Swiss Open, it was a new game for me. I had played her during the Thomas & Uber Cup as well, but I just gave my 100 per cent.

Q. There were close encounters in the quarter-final and semi-final, including an injury scare. How did you recover from the fatigue developed during those matches?
I was in pain because of my foot, but my physio, B. Evangeline, and my trainer, M. Srikanth Varma, were always there to take care of me. They made sure I was ready for the next day's match. We did ice baths, treatments in the pool and jacuzzi, and also sauna and steam.

Q. What would you consider to have been the biggest change in your mental space since the previous Commonwealth Games?
I would say I have more experience and my game has also changed. In a way, I've improved a lot, mentally and physically. When it comes to technique and skill, we've been training hard and improving well.

Q. The Commonwealth Games gold was missing from your kitty. How did you celebrate the win?
Well, yes, I was waiting for it and I finally got it. I'm very happy. I came back home and spent time with my family and celebrated with them. It's really good because I can say that I've completed the sequence—from bronze, to silver and now gold.

Q. How do you handle the pressure of being P.V. Sindhu?
I'm used to it. Pressure and responsibilities are always there, but I think it's important that when you go to the court, you think about yourself and play your game. Trying to do what people want you to will only mean adding extra pressure on yourself.

– with Shail Desai



"I'VE IMPROVED A LOT" Q+A

*After having finally won gold at this year's Commonwealth Games in Birmingham, shuttler **P.V. Sindhu** told us that the key to her success has been giving badminton her all*

BANDEEP SINGH